



Birla Institute of Technology & Science, Pilani

Pilani | Dubai | Goa | Hyderabad

ACADEMIC— UNDER GRADUATE STUDIES DIVISION

First Semester 2026-27 Course Handout Part II

Date: 1 August 2026

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Timetable), this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course Number : GS F232

Course Title : Introductory Psychology

Instructor-in-charge : Prof. Tanu Shukla (tanus@pilani.bits-pilani.ac.in, 6168-H)

- 1. Course description:** Psychology as a science, Perception, its nature, determinants, and measurement; Biological bases of behaviour; Consciousness, Motivation, and Emotion; Learning and behaviour modification; Memory and forgetting; Thought processes, Problem-solving, and Creative thinking; Individual differences—Intelligence, Gender, Personality, Stress, and Coping; Social thought and Social Behaviour; with an emphasis on psychological assessment, behavioural data, research analytics, and evidence-based decision-making.
- 2. Scope and Objective:** To develop a conceptual framework for understanding the human behaviour; relevance of psychology in daily life and its application in social, educational, industrial, personal and other spheres.
- 3. Course learning outcomes:**

CLO1. Explain the major concepts, theories, and principles of psychology, including the biological, cognitive, emotional, developmental, personality, and social foundations of human behaviour.

CLO2. Apply psychological principles to analyse everyday individual and social behaviour, decision-making, learning, motivation, stress, and interpersonal interactions.

CLO3. Compare and critically evaluate major psychological perspectives, theories, and empirical evidence to explain human thought, emotion, and behaviour.

CLO4. Demonstrate an understanding of psychological research methods, ethical principles, basic research design, and the interpretation of psychological data.

CLO5. Evaluate individual differences in perception, intelligence, personality, emotion, and behaviour using evidence-based psychological concepts and appropriate assessment approaches.

CLO6. Integrate psychological knowledge to promote self-awareness, effective communication, well-being, problem-solving, and responsible decision-making in academic, professional, and social contexts.

4. Text books and references:

TB1. Robert A. Baron, “Psychology”, Revised 5th Edition, Pearson, 2023

RB1. Ceccarelli & Meyer, Psychology, South Asian Edition, Pearson Longman, 2020

RB2. A. K. Singh, “Tests, Measurements and Research Methods in Behavioural Sciences”, Revised 4th Edition, Bharati Bhawan, 2019

5. Course Format & Weekly Workflow

weekly schedule for 14 weeks with [3] lectures per week

Wk no.	Module no.	Description	Ref.	Learning Outcome
1.	1.	Psychology : A Science & Perspective Modern Psychology: Definition, Origin, Classical Studies, Issues and Perspectives, Trends, Psychology in India, Development of psychology as a science; Individual and the environment	T1: Chapter 1	CLO 1
2.	2.	Research Methods in Psychology Psychology & the Scientific Method; Research Methods in Psychology- Observation, Correlation, Experimentation Method; Issues in Psychological Research	T1: Chapter 1	CLO 5
3.	3.	Biological Bases of Behavior Nervous System: Neurons as Building Blocks, Basic Structure and Functions, The Brain; The Brain and Human Behavior; Heredity and Behavior: Genetics & Evolutionary Psychology; Consciousness (Sleep, Dreams and Altered States)	T1: Chapter 2	CLO 1
4.	4.	Sensation & Perception: Making Contact with the World around us Sensation: The Raw Materials for Understanding; Vision; Hearing; Touch, Smell and Taste; Perception; The Plasticity of Perception	T1: Chapter 3	CLO 2

Wk no.	Module no.	Description	Ref.	Learning Outcome
5.	4.	Cognition: Thinking, Deciding & Communicating Thinking: Forming Concepts and Reasoning to Conclusions; Making decisions; Problem Solving; Language: The Communication of Information and Creative Thinking	T1: Chapter 7	CLO 3
6.	5.	Learning: How we're changed by Experience Learning: Classical Conditioning, Operant Conditioning, Observational Learning, Social Cognitive Learning Theories, Behaviour Modification through Learning	T1: Chapter 5	CLO 2
7.	6.	Memory: Of Things Remembered and Forgotten Human Memory; Kinds of Information Stored in Memory, Forgetting, Memory Distortion and Memory Construction, Memory in Everyday Life; Memory & Brain	T1: Chapter 6	CLO 2
8.	7.	Motivation Motivation; Theories of Motivation; Motives & Motivation- Hunger, Aggression, Achievement; Extrinsic and Intrinsic Motivation	T1: Chapter 10	CLO 3
9.	8.	Emotions Emotions: Their Nature, Expression & Impact	T1: Chapter 10	CLO 3
10.	9.	Intelligence: Cognitive, Practical, Emotional Intelligence: Contrasting Views of its nature; Measuring Intelligence; Human Intelligence: Role of Heredity and Environment; Group Differences in Intelligence;	T1: Chapter 11	CLO 4, CLO 5

Wk no.	Module no.	Description	Ref.	Learning Outcome
		Emotional Intelligence : The Feeling Side of Intelligence; Creativity: Generating the Extra ordinary, Gender Differences in Intelligence and Cognition		
11.	10.	Personality: Uniqueness and Consistency in the behaviour of Individuals Personality: What is it?; The Psychoanalytic Approach; Humanistic Theories, Trait Theories; Learning Approaches to Personality; Measuring Modern Research on Personality: Applications to Personal Health and Behavior in Work; Gender and Personality	T1: Chapter 12	CLO 4, CLO 5
12.	11.	Health, Stress & Coping Health Psychology; Stress- Causes, Effects and Control; Understanding and Communication of Health Needs; Behavioural and Psychological Correlates of Illness; Promoting Wellness: Developing a Healthier Lifestyle	T1: Chapter 13	CLO 4, CLO 6
13.	12.	Social Thought Social Thought- Social Perception, Attribution, Social Cognition, Attitudes;	T1: Chapter 16	CLO 5, CLO 6
14.	12.	Social Behaviour Social Behaviour- Prejudice & Discrimination, Social Influence, Attraction & Love, Leadership	T1: Chapter 16	CLO 4, CLO 6

6. Evaluation Scheme:

Component	Weightage	Duration	Date and time	Comments
Assessment 1	15 %	30 mins	TBA	Quiz (Open Book)
Mid Semester	30 %	90 min	As announced in the	Closed book

			timetable	
Assessment 2	15 %	30 mins	TBA	Quiz
Comprehensive	40 %	180 min	As announced in the timetable	Closed book

7. **Criterion for NC:** 20% of the average of the top three performers or 30% of the median, whichever is lower.
8. **Attendance Policy:** Each student is expected to attend all classes and participate in all evaluation components.
9. **Chamber consultation hours:** TBA
10. **Makeup Policy:** Makeup will be given only for genuine cases (accompanied by proof) for Mid-sem or comprehensive exam only.

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